SUGAR COSMETICS

Instagram Performance Analytics

Insights document and business summary

Period analysed: 19 Apr 2024 to 19 Apr 2025 | 50,000 posts | Post types: Image, Reel, Story, Video

Companion deliverables

- **Interactive dashboard** (HTML): https://claude.ai/artifact/HNFMXTuiiAsFfHA7UW4GxH - 9 views, filters for Post Type, Month, Hashtag and Campaign, click-to-filter actions.
- **Cleaned data for Tableau**: sugar_cosmetics_instagram_cleaned.csv (one row per post, with calculated fields) and sugar_cosmetics_hashtags_long.csv (one row per post-hashtag).
- **Appendix B** of this document: step-by-step instructions to rebuild all 10 sheets and the dashboard in Tableau Public.

1. Executive summary

The account is large and healthy on raw volume: **50,000 posts reached 987 million accounts**, collected 147.7 million likes, 18.5 million comments, 8.1 million shares and 8.9 million saves, and drove 8.9 million follows. The **average engagement rate is 18.5%** (likes + comments + shares + saves, divided by reach).

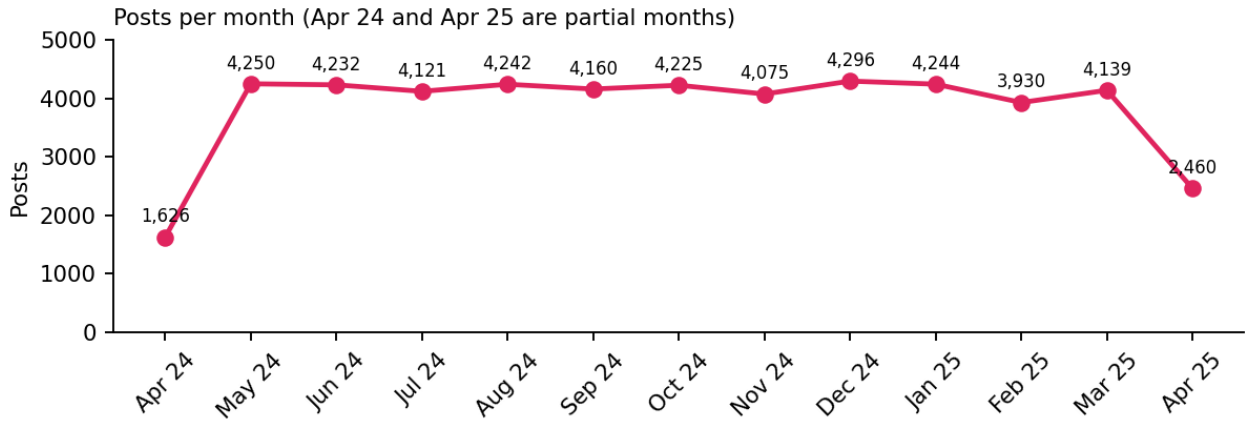
The single most important finding is that performance is almost perfectly uniform. Post format, weekday, campaign type, hashtag, audience emotion and engagement source all sit within about 0.2 percentage points of the overall average. A one-way ANOVA on engagement rate gives p-values of 0.15 (post type), 0.57 (weekday), 0.48 (campaign), 0.35 (source) and 0.56 (audience emotion): none are statistically significant. The only nominal signals are small: posts with one hashtag trail posts with two or three (18.44% vs 18.59%, p = 0.03), and organic posts reach slightly more accounts than paid posts (19,970 vs 19,617 on average, p = 0.01). Both would be weak after correcting for the number of comparisons made.

What this means for strategy: the data does not support picking a "winning" format or posting day. Gains are more likely to come from (1) reach and volume, (2) converting visibility into follows, and (3) running structured experiments, than from shifting mix between formats.

KPI	Value
Total posts	50,000
Total likes	147,728,279
Total comments	18,459,361
Total reach	987,423,288 (impressions 1,276,045,750)
Average engagement rate	18.54% (reach-weighted: 18.55%)
Shares / Saves	8,115,338 / 8,861,439
Profile visits / Follows	29,634,798 / 8,866,710

Engagement rate is calculated per post and then averaged, which is how Tableau's AVG() on a per-post calculated field behaves.

2. Posting consistency and trend



Output is steady at roughly 4,000 to 4,300 posts per month (about 137 per day). The lower first and last bars are partial months, not a decline. February is lower only because it is shorter. There is no growth or stagnation signal in the posting rate, and engagement rate by month stays between 18.3% and 18.7%. Follows also hold at 700K to 760K per full month, so **account growth is flat, not accelerating**.

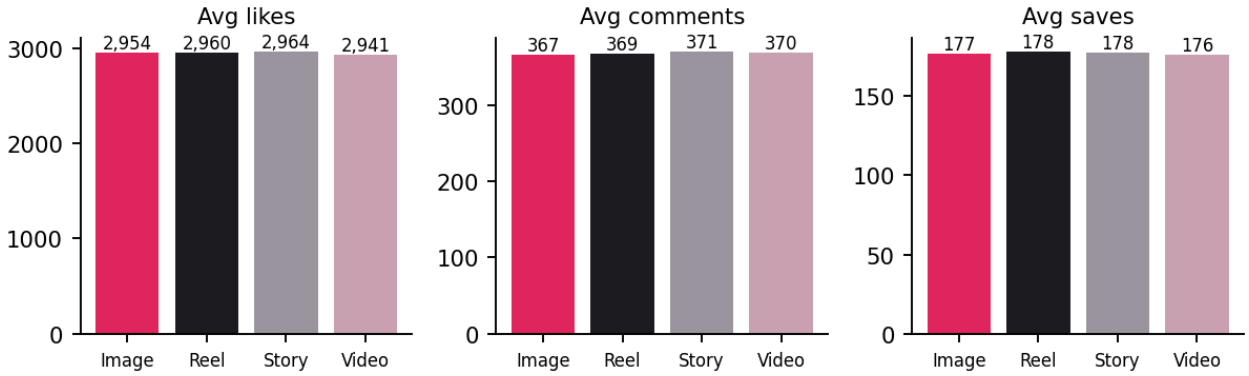
3. Top posts

By likes. The ten most-liked posts have 11,043 to 11,392 likes each, all on posts with reach of about 44,000 to 47,000. They span every format (Reel, Image, Video, Story) and campaign type (Influencer Collab leads with three of the top ten, Giveaway three, Product Launch two, Festive Offer two). Likes follow reach almost one-for-one, so the most-liked posts are simply the widest-reaching ones.

By engagement rate. The top ten engagement rates are 33.8% to 34.1%. These are different posts: reach as low as 7,181 and as high as 38,468. They are the "hidden gems" the brief asks about: modest reach, strong interaction. Posts with an engagement rate above 30% make up about 4.5% of the account. Reach and engagement rate are essentially uncorrelated (r = 0.004), so being seen widely does not predict interacting deeply, and vice versa.

Note: the dataset has no caption column, so posts are identified by date, format, campaign, source and hashtags (the dashboard lists these for each of the top ten).

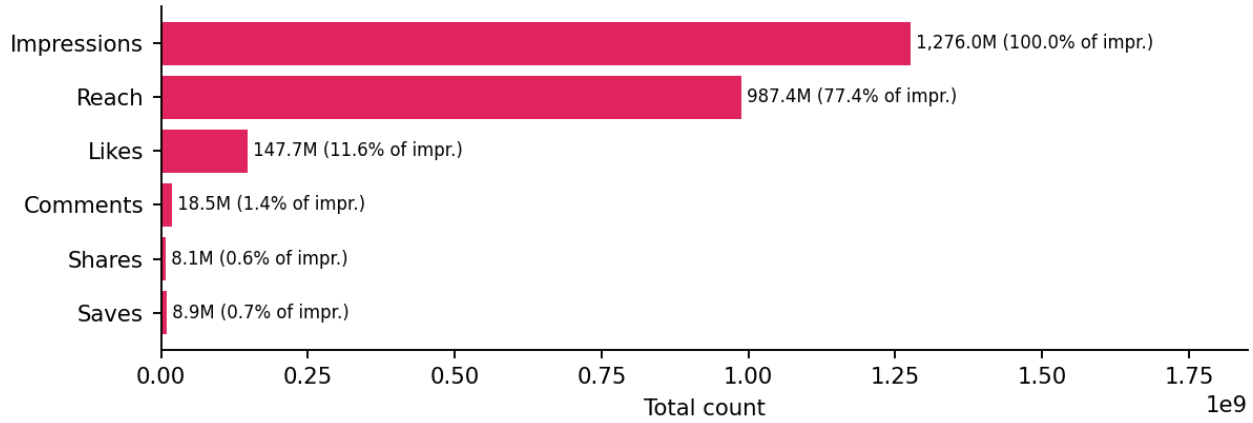
4. Format and weekday performance



Post type	Avg likes	Avg comments	Avg saves	Avg ER
Image	2,954	367	177	18.43%
Reel	2,960	369	178	18.61%
Story	2,964	371	178	18.60%
Video	2,941	370	176	18.51%

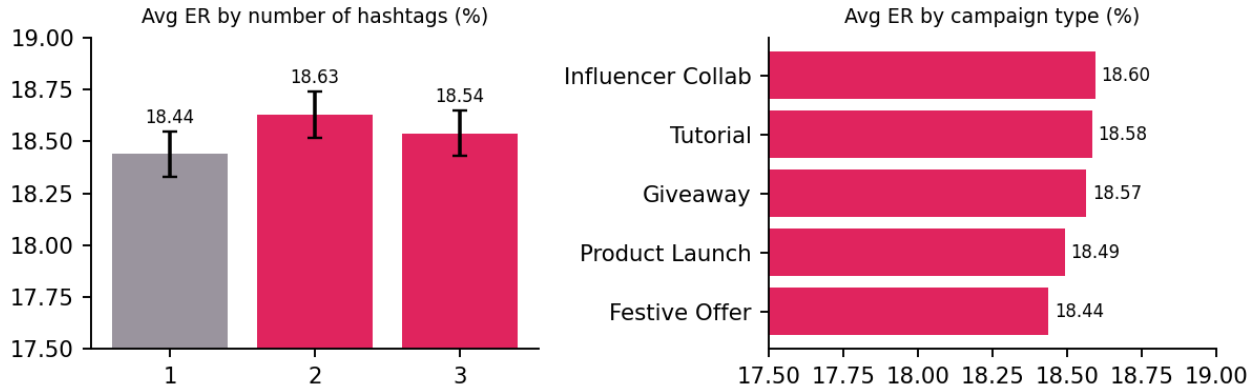
Reels and Stories lead on engagement rate and Image trails, but the full gap is 0.18 percentage points. By weekday, Wednesday is highest (18.63%) and Sunday lowest (18.42%): a 0.21 point gap, not significant. Weekday averages for likes range only from 2,926 (Saturday) to 2,974 (Wednesday).

5. Engagement funnel



Of 1.28 billion impressions, **77.4% are unique reach** (so each reached account sees a post about 1.3 times). Likes equal 15.0% of reach, comments 1.9%, shares 0.8% and saves 0.9%. Likes make up **81% of all interactions**. Reach-to-profile-visit conversion is 3.0%, and 29.9% of profile visits become a follow (0.9% of reach). The sharpest drop is from likes to the deeper actions: shares and saves, the signals of virality and purchase intent, are about 5 to 6 times rarer than comments and roughly 17 to 18 times rarer than likes.

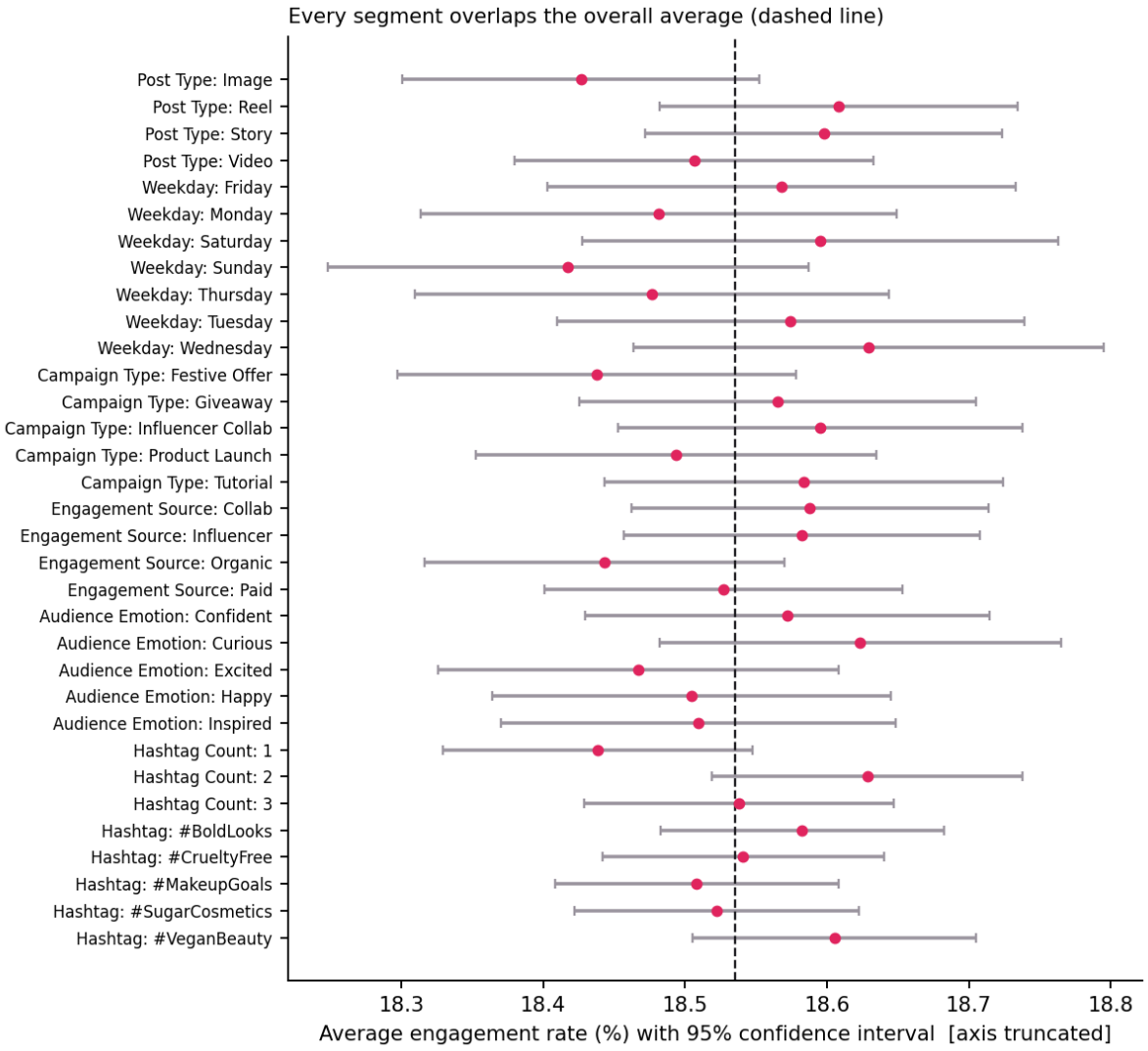
6. Hashtags and campaigns



Hashtags are stored as lists (for example "#BoldLooks, #MakeupGoals"), so each post was split into individual hashtags (85 distinct combinations of five tags). All five hashtags perform the same: 18.51% (#MakeupGoals) to 18.61% (#VeganBeauty), and each appears on about 20,000 posts. The number of hashtags shows the only visible pattern: one hashtag averages 18.44% versus 18.63% for two and 18.54% for three. Among three-tag combinations, rates range from 17.5% to 19.5%, but with about 280 posts per combination this spread is what random variation alone would produce, so it should be treated as a hypothesis to test, not a finding.

Campaign types are equally flat. Influencer Collab leads (18.60% ER, 2,983 average likes) and Festive Offer is last (18.44%, 2,903 average likes).

7. Full-picture check


Every segment overlaps the overall average (dashed line)
Post Type: Image
Post Type: Reel
Post Type: Story
Post Type: Video
Weekday: Friday
Weekday: Monday
Weekday: Saturday
Weekday: Sunday
Weekday: Thursday
Weekday: Tuesday
Weekday: Wednesday
Campaign Type: Festive Offer
Campaign Type: Giveaway
Campaign Type: Influencer Collab
Campaign Type: Product Launch
Campaign Type: Tutorial
Engagement Source: Collab
Engagement Source: Influencer
Engagement Source: Organic
Engagement Source: Paid
Audience Emotion: Confident
Audience Emotion: Curious
Audience Emotion: Excited
Audience Emotion: Happy
Audience Emotion: Inspired
Hashtag Count: 1
Hashtag Count: 2
Hashtag Count: 3
Hashtag: #BoldLooks
Hashtag: #CrueltyFree
Hashtag: #MakeupGoals
Hashtag: #SugarCosmetics
Hashtag: #VeganBeauty
18.3
18.4
18.5
18.6
18.7
18.8
Average engagement rate (%) with 95% confidence interval [axis truncated]

8. Strategic recommendations

Key takeaways

- The account performs strongly in volume (987M reach) and interaction (18.5% ER), and does so consistently across every cut.
- No format, day, hashtag or campaign shows a meaningful, reliable advantage. Optimising the mix between these will not move results much on current evidence.
- Likes dominate (81% of interactions). Shares and saves, the stronger commercial signals, are under 1% of reach each.
- Follower growth is steady rather than accelerating: about 0.9 follows per 100 reached accounts.

Recommended posting strategy

- **Timing:** keep the current daily cadence and post every day of the week. There is no evidence for dropping any weekday. Add post time-of-day to the data so timing can actually be tested.
- **Frequency:** maintain about 4,000+ posts a month. Treat volume, not format, as the lever, since reach scales likes almost one-for-one.
- **Content types:** keep all four formats. Lean slightly toward Reels and Stories (highest ER), and use Influencer Collab and Tutorial campaigns as the default creative frame.
- **Hashtags:** use two or three hashtags per post rather than one. Rotate #VeganBeauty and #CrueltyFree for values-led posts and #SugarCosmetics for brand posts.

Improving engagement and follower growth

- Add share and save prompts (checklists, "save for later" tutorials, shade guides, gift-giving posts) to lift the 0.8% and 0.9% rates.
- Replicate the high-engagement "hidden gem" posts: review the top-ten ER list for common creative traits (hook, length, offer) since format alone does not explain them.
- Add a profile call to action to the best-reaching posts: only 3.0% of reached accounts visit the profile, and 29.9% of visitors follow.
- Test whether paid spend is justified: paid posts reach slightly fewer accounts than organic (19,617 vs 19,970 average) with a near-identical ER.

Gaps in the data and how to close them

- **No captions:** add the caption column to analyse themes, length, CTAs and keywords.
- **No follower count or posting time:** add both so engagement can be benchmarked per follower and posting hour can be tested.
- **Scale check:** 137 posts per day from one account is unusually high, and an 18.5% reach-based ER is far above typical Instagram benchmarks of a few percent. Confirm whether the file combines several accounts or is a sample, and confirm how reach was recorded, before presenting absolute numbers externally.
- **Partial months:** April 2024 and April 2025 hold under a full month of data, so compare them with care.

Proposed campaign and test ideas

- **"Save the Look" tutorial series:** Reel + Story pairs ending with a save prompt, targeting a saves rate lift.
- **Cruelty-Free Collab drops:** influencer collaborations built on #CrueltyFree and #VeganBeauty, the brand's values positioning.
- **Festive offers rebuilt:** Festive Offer is the weakest campaign on likes and ER; test stronger creative and giveaway mechanics.
- **Four-week A/B plan:** change one variable at a time (hashtag count, CTA wording, posting hour) with matched posts, and use significance testing before changing strategy.

Appendix A. Data notes

- Source: sugar_cosmetics_instagram_data.xlsx, 50,000 rows, 14 columns, no missing values, no duplicate rows, no impossible values (reach never exceeds impressions; follows never exceed profile visits).
- The dataset differs from the brief: it has no caption column and it adds Campaign Type, Audience Emotion, Engagement Source, Profile Visits and Follows. Post_Type has Image, Reel, Story and Video (no Carousel).
- Derived fields: Engagement = Likes + Comments + Shares + Saves; Engagement Rate = Engagement / Reach; Month_Year; Weekday; Hashtag_Count; Follow_Rate = Follows / Profile Visits; Reach_Rate = Reach / Impressions; Post_ID.

Appendix B. Rebuilding in Tableau Public

Tableau Public workbooks (.twbx) can only be created and published from Tableau itself, so I could not produce one directly. The interactive HTML dashboard replicates every view; follow these steps to build the same thing in Tableau.

Setup

- Connect to **sugar_cosmetics_instagram_cleaned.csv**. Then drag **sugar_cosmetics_hashtags_long.csv** onto the canvas and relate the two on Post_ID.
- Calculated fields: **Engagement** = [Likes]+[Comments]+[Shares]+[Saves]; **Engagement Rate** = [Engagement]/[Reach]; **Month-Year** = DATETRUNC('month',[Post Date]); **Weekday** = DATENAME('weekday',[Post Date]); **Post Label** = STR([Post Date])+" | "+[Post Type]+" | "+[Campaign Type].

Sheet name	How to build
1 KPI Overview	Text table or big-number tiles: COUNT(Post ID), SUM(Likes), SUM(Comments), SUM(Reach), AVG(Engagement Rate). Format ER as percentage.
2 Monthly Posting Trend	Columns: Month-Year (continuous or discrete month). Rows: COUNT(Post ID). Line mark, with labels.
3 Top 10 by Likes	Rows: Post ID and Post Label; Columns: SUM(Likes). Filter Post ID > Top > 10 by SUM(Likes). Sort descending.
4 Top 10 by Engagement Rate	Same as sheet 3, but Top 10 by AVG(Engagement Rate).
5 Post Type Performance	Rows: Post Type. Columns: Measure Names with AVG(Likes), AVG(Comments), AVG(Saves) as Measure Values (grouped bars).
6 Day of Week Analysis	Rows: Weekday (sort Mon to Sun). Columns: AVG(Engagement Rate). Bar chart.
7 Engagement Funnel	Pivot or use Measure Values: SUM of Impressions, Reach, Likes, Comments, Shares, Saves. Sort descending, bars centered (or use a dual-axis mirrored bar for funnel shape).
8 Hashtag Analysis	Using the hashtags-long table: Rows: Hashtag. Columns: AVG(Engagement Rate) and AVG(Reach). Sort descending.
9 Final Dashboard	Add sheets 1-8. Put Post Type, Month-Year, Hashtag and Campaign Type filters on the dashboard (Apply to Worksheets > Selected Worksheets). Enable "Use as Filter" on Post Type, Weekday and Hashtag charts. Add a title, consistent colors (pink #e0245e and black), and tooltips.
10 Strategic Recommendation	Use sections 1 and 8 of this document as the story points and slide text.